

Russell Dudek

Senior Manager, Business Process Excellence · PMI

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Hiring Team
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PMI's transformation creates a process-excellence problem that is more consequential than eliminating waste. A global enterprise is scaling a fast-growing smoke-free portfolio while still operating across different products, markets, channels, systems, and regulatory realities. The central question is how to know what must stay stable, what may legitimately vary, where process debt is hiding, and when evidence justifies changing the standard.

That is the work I have spent my career doing from inside operations. At Vape-Jet, I lead AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows. At Amazon, I built operating mechanisms and escalation paths in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually. At Compunetics, I led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and high-reliability technical programs.

My thesis for the role is practical: Business Process Excellence should function as a **Process Genome**. Define the stable enterprise core of a process. Make legitimate market or regulatory variants explicit and reviewable. Expose harmful mutations such as workarounds, duplicate approvals, hidden queues, and zombie exceptions. Evolve the standard only when evidence shows a better way to create value, control risk, and sustain adoption.

I would bring AI into the role with restraint. Automation is not the objective; better work is. Simplify and clarify the process first, then use AI or automation where context is sufficient, authority is explicit, economics are credible, and human judgment remains where consequence or ambiguity requires it.

The obvious concern is that I have not spent my career inside tobacco or nicotine. That concern is fair. I would not confuse adjacent experience with domain mastery. What I bring is direct experience across manufacturing, quality, logistics, enterprise workflows, regulated operations, technical customer delivery, and AI-enabled work—plus a record of learning complex systems quickly and translating them into mechanisms people can use.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss where PMI's greatest process friction sits today, how the organization distinguishes legitimate variation from process debt, and what success in this role must change for both executives and frontline users.

Carpe diem,
Russell Dudek